MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

SPELLING & GRAMMAR • 2-PAGE SPREAD MASTERY

LEVEL 1



SPELLING & GRAMMAR
MASTERY GUIDE

The complete self-study & revision workbook for a confident Level 1 writing pass

SPELLING RULES | SENTENCE DEMARCATION | EVERYDAY PUNCTUATION | FULL ANSWER KEY

SPAG LEVEL 1

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar

Level 1 • Core Principles, Everyday Work Scenarios & Applied Practice

This book belongs to:	Exam date:	Target level:

What is inside

1–4	Diagnostic Assessment & Skill Routing	p. 3
5–56	26 Two-Page Murphy 'Grammar in Use' Units	p. 7
57–68	6 Visual Vocabulary in Use Modules	p. 59
69–80	12 Practical Proofreading & Grammar Drills	p. 71
81–88	4 Realistic Workplace Writing Tasks	p. 83
89–98	Comprehensive Explanatory Answer Keys	p. 91
99	Candidate Self-Audit & Progress Matrix	p. 99

How to use this book

Read
Read the rule. Study the picture.

Try
Write your answers on the lines.

Check
Mark it with the answers at the back.

Remember
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 1–3

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 1 of 4

Answer each question carefully. Circle your chosen answer. Do not use a dictionary.

1 **Which sentence capitalises all proper nouns, days, and the pronoun 'I' correctly?** (Unit 1: Capital Letters) **(1 mark)**

- ☐ Every tuesday, i travel to Leeds with mr Davies.
- ☐ Every Tuesday, I travel to Leeds with Mr Davies.
- ☐ Every tuesday, I travel to Leeds with Mr davies.

2 **Identify the option that forms two complete, correctly punctuated sentences:** (Unit 2: Full Stops & Run-ons) **(1 mark)**

- ☐ The shop opened early today there were fifty customers waiting.
- ☐ The shop opened early today. There were fifty customers waiting.
- ☐ The shop opened early today, there were fifty customers waiting.

3 **Which sentence requires an exclamation mark to signal urgent danger?** (Unit 3: Question Marks & Exclamations) **(1 mark)**

- ☐ Can you please check the fire exit door
- ☐ Warning! Flammable materials stored in this locker!
- ☐ The fire exit door is located on the second floor

✎ Examiner Checkpoint • Questions 1 to 3 Notes

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 4–6

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 2 of 4

Identify correct capitalization, punctuation, and sentence construction.

4 **Select the sentence that uses commas correctly in a list:** (Unit 4: Commas in Lists) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] The toolkit contains hammers screwdrivers spanners, and pliers.
- [ ] The toolkit contains hammers, screwdrivers, spanners and pliers.
- [ ] The toolkit contains, hammers screwdrivers, spanners and pliers.

5 **Choose the sentence with correct contraction apostrophes:** (Unit 5: Contraction Apostrophes) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] You shouldnt enter if you dont have your visitor badge.
- [ ] You shouldn't enter if you don't have your visitor badge.
- [ ] You should'nt enter if you do'nt have your visitor badge.

6 **Which sentence correctly shows that the locker belongs to one worker?** (Unit 6: Possessive Apostrophes) **(1 mark)**

- [ ] The worker's locker was inspected by the supervisor.
- [ ] The workers locker was inspected by the supervisor.
- [ ] The workers's locker was inspected by the supervisor.

✎ Examiner Checkpoint • Questions 4 to 6 Notes

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 7–8

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 3 of 4

Grammar and syntax accuracy questions, followed by the diagnostic benchmark rubric.

7 **Which option is a complete sentence (not a fragment)?** (Unit 7: Complete Sentences) **(1 mark)**

- ☐ Because the delivery lorry arrived an hour late.
- ☐ When sorting the packages into the blue delivery bins.
- ☐ The driver unloaded all forty parcels onto the ramp.

8 **Choose the best joining word: 'The team worked overtime, [_____] the order was finished on time.'** (Unit 8: Joining Words (Conjunctions)) **(1 mark)**

☐ but ☐ so ☐ because

Diagnostic Performance Matrix & Recommended Study Pathway

Score Range	Readiness Level	Recommended Curriculum Route
8 – 10 Marks	Strong Level 1 Foundation	Focus on proofreading speed, complex punctuation (Units 4, 6 & 10), and exam accuracy.
5 – 7 Marks	Developing SPaG Skills	Carefully review sentence boundaries, subject-verb matching, and apostrophe rules (Units 2, 5, 6 & 9).
0 – 4 Marks	Priority Core Revision	Work through all 11 units systematically using the Murphy 2-page practice spreads.

✎ Personal Learning Target & Study Priority

DIAGNOSTIC AUDIT • QUESTIONS 9–10 & STUDY PLAN

Baseline Diagnostic Assessment • Part 4 of 4

Final practical diagnostic questions and your personalized revision action plan.

9 **Select the sentence with correct singular/plural verb matching:** **(1 mark)**

(Unit 9: Subject-Verb Agreement)

- ☐ Both apprentices was awarded their certificates.
- ☐ Both apprentices were awarded their certificates.
- ☐ Both apprentices is awarded their certificates.

10 **Choose the correct words: 'Please put [_____] jackets over [_____].'** (Unit 11: Everyday Homophones) **(1 mark)**

☐ there / their ☐ their / there ☐ they're / there

Tutor Golden Rule

Check your diagnostic score against the answer keys on page 91.

Revision Target

Prioritise the specific units flagged in questions you found challenging.

✎ Candidate Action Plan & Priority Units to Master

UNIT 1 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

1 Sentence Basics — Capital Letters & Full Stops



Abdul

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Shift Handover Log & Daily Operational Notes

B Complete Sentence Architecture: Subject + Finite Verb + Complete Thought

A complete grammatical sentence must express a single finished thought and contain two essential pillars:

Capital Letter → **[Subject: Who/What]** + **[Finite Verb: Action/State]** + **[Complete Sense]** → **Full Stop (.)**

- **Sentence Fragment:** Missing a finite verb or subject (e.g. *"Because the conveyor stopped."* — this is an incomplete dependent clause).
- **Run-on Sentence:** Two independent sentences fused together with no terminal punctuation (e.g. *"The conveyor stopped the engineer arrived."*).
- **Full Stop Rule:** Conclude every declarative sentence with a solid full stop (.). The subsequent sentence must open with a crisp capital letter.

× Common Mistake

the morning shift finished at eight all safety gates was locked secure. Because the team followed protocol.

✓ Correct Sentence

The morning shift finished at eight. All safety gates were locked securely because the team followed protocol.

Why: Capitalised the sentence starters ('The', 'All'), split the run-on with a full stop, and joined the dangling fragment into a complete causal sentence.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence contains both a capital letter and a correct terminal full stop?

- [ ] the warehouse shutter opened at dawn.
- [ ] The warehouse shutter opened at dawn.
- [ ] The warehouse shutter opened at dawn

2 Identify the sentence fragment that cannot stand alone as a complete sentence:

- [ ] Forklift 3 passed its hydraulic inspection.
- [ ] After the technician tested the emergency brake.
- [ ] We ordered replacement filters this morning.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

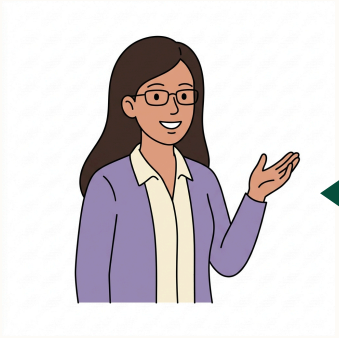
3 **[Rewrite with capital letter and full stop]:** *the delivery docket was signed by the depot manager*

4 **[Split the fused run-on into two sentences]:** *safety helmets are mandatory visitors must sign in*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 1.

UNIT 2 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

2 Question Marks vs Exclamation Marks in Customer Service



Priya

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Customer Helpdesk & Client Correspondence

★ B Direct Inquiry vs Urgent Exclamation Grammar

Punctuation governs customer tone and transactional clarity:

[Direct Question] → **Inversion (Auxiliary + Subject)** → **Question Mark (?)**

[Safety Hazard / Urgent Warning] → **High Alarm** → **Exclamation Mark (!)** **(Maximum ONE)**

- **Direct Question:** Requires an answer or action from the reader (e.g. *"Would you prefer a refund or an exchange?"*). Conclude with a question mark.
- **Indirect Statement:** Do not place a question mark on indirect reported questions (e.g. *"The customer asked if the parcel had arrived."* — end with a full stop).
- **Exclamation Control:** Reserved exclusively for urgent hazard warnings (e.g. *"Caution! Wet floor."*). Never use multiple marks (*!!* or *!?!?*) in workplace writing.

× Common Mistake

Could you please confirm your invoice number. Hurry up and reply immediately!!!

✓ Correct Sentence

Could you please confirm your invoice number? Please reply at your earliest convenience.

Why: Replaced the careless full stop with a required question mark and eliminated triple exclamation marks to maintain polite professional composure.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence requires a question mark at the end?

- [ ] I am writing to ask about your return policy.
- [ ] Could you confirm your tracking reference number
- [ ] We received your replacement order yesterday.

2 Select the sentence with professional, appropriate exclamation mark usage:

- [ ] Warning! Isolate electrical supply before opening panel.
- [ ] Thanks for your email today!!!!!!
- [ ] Please help me right now!!!

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Add the correct terminal mark (? or .)]:** *Would you like me to reserve the appointment for Thursday*

4 **[Remove informal exclamation marks]:** *Your order has been dispatched today!!! Have a lovely weekend!!*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 2.

UNIT 3 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

3 Capital Letters for Proper Nouns, Acronyms & Titles (MINTS)



Marcus

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Conference Registration & Corporate Identity

★ B The MINTS Framework for Flawless Capitalisation

Remember the five essential categories that demand capital letters:

(M) **Months & Days** • (I) **The Pronoun 'I'** • (N) **Names & Places** • (T) **Titles & Headings** • (S) **Start of Sentences**

- **Months & Days:** Always capitalise *Monday, Friday, January, September.* Do not capitalise general seasons (*spring, autumn*) unless part of a proper title.
- **Names, Places & Nationalities:** *Sarah Jenkins, Manchester, British, English, NHS.*
- **Job Titles & Honorifics:** Capitalise specific individual titles (*Dr Evans, Prime Minister, General Manager Patel*), but use lowercase for general job roles (*our manager, the technician*).
- **Acronyms:** Initialisms and acronyms are set in full capitals: *UK, Ofqual, PPE, CCTV, HR.*

× Common Mistake

on wednesday, i accompanied dr green to manchester general hospital to inspect the new ppe store.

✓ Correct Sentence

On Wednesday, I accompanied Dr Green to Manchester General Hospital to inspect the new PPE store.

Why: Applied capitals to day ('Wednesday'), pronoun ('I'), title ('Dr Green'), hospital proper name ('Manchester General Hospital'), and acronym ('PPE').

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence capitalises all days, months, and proper nouns correctly?

- ☐ The audit begins on Tuesday, 14 october at St Mary's clinic.
- ☐ The audit begins on Tuesday, 14 October at St Mary's Clinic.
- ☐ The audit begins on tuesday, 14 October at St Mary's clinic.

2 Select the sentence where the pronoun 'I' and job titles are handled accurately:

- ☐ After meeting Director Patel, i completed the health assessment.
- ☐ After meeting director Patel, I completed the health assessment.
- ☐ After meeting Director Patel, I completed the health assessment.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

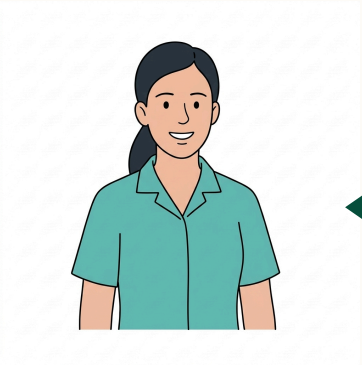
3 **[Capitalise days and months]:** *the staff training commences on friday, 4 november*

4 **[Correct the pronoun and proper noun]:** *yesterday i met david brown at leeds central station*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 3.

UNIT 4 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

4 Joining Sentences with Coordinating Conjunctions (And, But, Or, So)



Sarah

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Incident Log & Risk Assessment Updates

★ B The FANBOYS Toolkit: Coordinating Equal Clauses

Coordinating conjunctions connect two independent, grammatically equal clauses:

[Independent Clause 1] + **,** **[and / but / or / so]** + **[Independent Clause 2]**

- **AND:** Adds similar information (e.g. *"The fire alarm sounded, and all staff evacuated immediately."*).
- **BUT:** Signals an unexpected contrast (e.g. *"The engineer arrived on time, but the replacement valve was missing."*).
- **OR:** Offers choices or alternatives (e.g. *"You can submit the paper timesheet, or you can log your hours online."*).
- **SO:** Shows a direct logical result (e.g. *"The access road was flooded, so deliveries were redirected."*).

× Common Mistake

The forklift battery died. The operator plugged it in. The backup charger was broken.

✓ Correct Sentence

The forklift battery died, so the operator plugged it in, but the backup charger was broken.

Why: Combined choppy repetitive fragments using 'so' (logical outcome) and 'but' (contrast), improving flow and cohesion.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the best conjunction to show a contrast: *'We ordered fifty safety vests, [_____] only twenty arrived.'*

☐ and ☐ but ☐ so

2 Choose the conjunction indicating a result: *'The printer toner was empty, [_____] Marcus replaced the cartridge.'*

☐ or ☐ but ☐ so

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

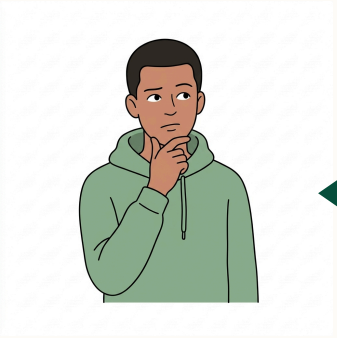
3 **[Join with 'but' to show contrast]:** *The technician tested the heating unit. It failed the safety check.*

4 **[Join with 'so' to show a result]:** *The delivery lorry arrived early. The stock team unloaded the goods.*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 4.

UNIT 5 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

5 Joining Sentences with Subordinating Conjunctions (Because, Although, When)



Sam

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Staff Performance Appraisal & Action Planning

B Complex Sentence Hierarchy: Main Clause + Subordinate Clause

A complex sentence contains an independent main clause and a dependent subordinate clause:

[Main Clause] + **[because / although / when / if]** + **[Subordinate Clause]**

[Subordinating Conjunction] + **[Subordinate Clause]** + **,** + **[Main Clause]**

- **BECAUSE (Reason):** *"Hannah exceeded her sales target because she phoned prospective clients daily."*
- **ALTHOUGH (Concession):** *"Although the software crashed twice, James submitted the payroll report on schedule."*
- **WHEN / IF (Condition/Time):** *"When the customer arrives, please escort them to Meeting Room 3."*
- **Comma Rule:** When the subordinate clause comes FIRST, place a comma after it. When it comes second, no comma is required.

× Common Mistake

Because Priya completed her training course early. She was promoted to team leader.

✓ Correct Sentence

Because Priya completed her training course early, she was promoted to team leader.

Why: Removed the incorrect full stop that isolated the subordinate clause into a fragment, adding a required comma before the main clause.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the subordinating conjunction showing concession: *'[_____] the team was short-staffed, they finished all patient rounds.'*

- ☐ Because
- ☐ Although
- ☐ When

2 Which sentence is punctuated correctly with a subordinate clause at the start?

- ☐ When the alarm rings please evacuate to Assembly Point A.
- ☐ When the alarm rings, please evacuate to Assembly Point A.
- ☐ When, the alarm rings please evacuate.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Combine using 'because' at the beginning]:** *The clinic postponed appointments. The heating system broke down.*

4 **[Combine using 'although' in the middle]:** *Leon passed his driving test. He was extremely nervous.*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 5.

UNIT 6 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

6 Commas in Everyday Lists of Items & Actions



Abdul

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Catering Stock Orders & Kitchen Inventory

★ B Listing Mechanics: Items, Adjectives & Actions

Commas separate three or more items, modifiers, or verb phrases in a series:

[Item 1] , [Item 2] , [Item 3] and [Item 4]

- **Serial Commas:** Use commas between every item in a list of three or more nouns (e.g. *"Please order milk, butter, cheddar cheese and double cream."*).
- **Actions in Series:** Separate consecutive verb phrases (e.g. *"The technician checked the fluid level, replaced the gasket, cleaned the housing and tested the pump."*).
- **Two Items Only:** Never insert a comma when joining only two items (e.g. *"Order bread and butter."* NOT *"Order bread, and butter."*).
- **The 'And' Rule:** In standard Level 1 UK writing, do not place a comma immediately before or after 'and' unless required to prevent ambiguity.

× Common Mistake

The pantry order requires flour sugar eggs, baking powder, and, vanilla essence.

✓ Correct Sentence

The pantry order requires flour, sugar, eggs, baking powder and vanilla essence.

Why: Inserted missing commas between the first three items and deleted unnecessary commas around 'and'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence punctuates a list of office supplies correctly?

- ☐ We ordered pens paper clips envelopes and printer ink.
- ☐ We ordered pens, paper clips, envelopes and printer ink.
- ☐ We ordered, pens paper clips envelopes and printer ink.

2 Identify the sentence that incorrectly adds a comma between two items only:

- ☐ The apprentice repaired the faulty plug, and fitted the new fuse.
- ☐ The apprentice repaired the faulty plug and fitted the new fuse.
- ☐ The apprentice checked both cables.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

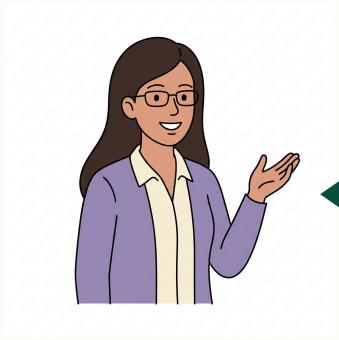
3 **[Add missing list commas]:** *The tool chest holds pliers screwdrivers wire strippers and a tape measure*

4 **[Remove commas from a two-item phrase]:** *Every morning we inspect the forklift, and clean the loading bay*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 6.

UNIT 7 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

7 Commas after Introductory Phrases & Time Words



Priya

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Fire Evacuation & Security Operating Procedures

★ B Introductory Fronting: Time, Place & Manner Phrases

When an introductory phrase or time word opens a sentence, set it off with a comma:

[Introductory Time / Transition Word] + **,** + **[Subject]** + **[Main Action / Instruction]**

- **Time Words & Sequencing:** *First, Next, Finally, Yesterday, At 08:30, Last Tuesday* (e.g. *"Last Monday, the fire marshals conducted an unannounced drill."*).
- **Introductory Prepositional Phrases:** *In the event of a fire, Under health and safety regulations, Before operating the machinery* (e.g. *"In the event of an alarm, leave your belongings."*).
- **Transition Linkers:** *However, Therefore, In addition, For example, Furthermore* (e.g. *"However, the second stairwell remained blocked."*).

× Common Mistake

Yesterday morning our safety representative checked all twenty fire doors.

✓ Correct Sentence

Yesterday morning, our safety representative checked all twenty fire doors.

Why: Placed a comma after the introductory time phrase ('Yesterday morning') to create a clear boundary before the main clause.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence places a comma correctly after an introductory time phrase?

- [ ] In September the new apprentices begin their rotations.
- [ ] In September, the new apprentices begin their rotations.
- [ ] In, September the new apprentices begin their rotations.

2 Select the sentence with correct punctuation after a workplace transition word:

- [ ] However the fire exit was blocked by wooden pallets.
- [ ] However, the fire exit was blocked by wooden pallets.
- [ ] However; the fire exit was blocked by wooden pallets.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Insert a comma after the time phrase]:** *Last Friday our team completed the quarterly stocktake*

4 **[Punctuate the transition linker]:** *In addition staff must wear protective eyewear in the machining bay*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 7.

UNIT 8 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

8 Apostrophes for Contractions (Don't, Can't, Wouldn't)



Marcus

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Staff Shift Cover & Immediate Operational Messaging

B Contraction Mechanics: The Apostrophe Replaces Missing Letters

An apostrophe of contraction marks exactly where letters have been omitted when two words merge:

do not → don't **(omits 'o')** • cannot → can't **(omits 'no')** • would not → wouldn't **(omits 'o')**

- **Exact Letter Replacement:** The apostrophe sits inside the word precisely where the missing letter used to be (e.g. *does not → doesn't*; NOT *does'nt*).
- **Top Contractions:** *isn't, aren't, hasn't, haven't, didn't, won't, it's (= it is).*
- **Exam Awareness:** In formal letters and incident reports, examiners prefer full uncontracted forms (*do not, will not*), but in informal emails and chat logs, contractions must be formed flawlessly.

× Common Mistake

We could'nt open the safe because the supervisor has'nt arrived and they dont have the key.

✓ Correct Sentence

We couldn't open the safe because the supervisor hasn't arrived and they don't have the key.

Why: Corrected misplaced apostrophes in 'couldn't' and 'hasn't' (between 'n' and 't'), and added the missing apostrophe to 'don't'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which contraction is spelled with the apostrophe in the correct position?

☐ did'nt ☐ didn't ☐ didnt

2 Choose the correct contracted form of *'we will'*:

☐ we'll ☐ well ☐ w'ell

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

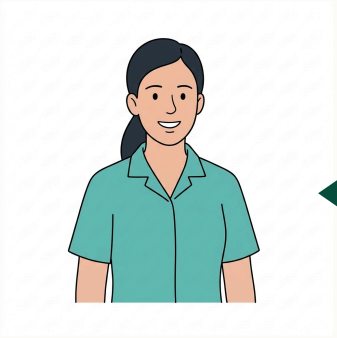
3 **[Contract 'they have not']:** *they have not received the delivery*

4 **[Correct the misplaced apostrophe]:** *the driver was'nt able to reverse into bay 3*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 8.

UNIT 9 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

9 Apostrophes for Singular Possession (The customer's order)



Sarah

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Customer Returns Desk & Lost Property Ledger

★ B Singular Ownership Architecture: Singular Noun + 's

To show that ONE person, animal, or entity owns something, add an apostrophe followed by 's':

[Singular Owner: Noun] + **'s** + **[Item Possessed]**

- **Singular Ownership:** *the customer's order* (one customer), *the doctor's signature* (one doctor), *the company's policy* (one company).
- **Names Ending in -s:** For singular names ending in -s, add 's in modern functional English (e.g. *James's locker, Charles's coat*).
- **No Ownership = No Apostrophe:** Simple plurals do not take an apostrophe (e.g. *"Five customers waited"* NOT *"Five customer's waited"*).
- **Its vs It's:** *Its* (no apostrophe) shows possession (e.g. *"The cat licked its paw; the printer lost its power"*). *It's* ALWAYS means *it is*.

× Common Mistake

We found the drivers phone in the managers office near the staff lockers.

✓ Correct Sentence

We found the driver's phone in the manager's office near the staff lockers.

Why: Added apostrophes to show singular ownership: one driver owned the phone ('driver's'), and one manager occupied the office ('manager's').

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence correctly indicates that an umbrella belongs to one customer?

- ☐ The customers umbrella was left at reception.
- ☐ The customer's umbrella was left at reception.
- ☐ The customers' umbrella was left at reception.

2 Choose the option demonstrating correct singular possession for an employee's tool:

- ☐ The electrician's multimeter passed calibration.
- ☐ The electricians multimeter passed calibration.
- ☐ The electrican's multimeter passed calibration.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Make singular possessive: the locker of the nurse]:** *the locker belonging to the nurse*

_____

_____

4 **[Insert the singular possessive apostrophe]:** *We received the client signature on yesterday contract*

_____

_____

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 9.

_____

_____

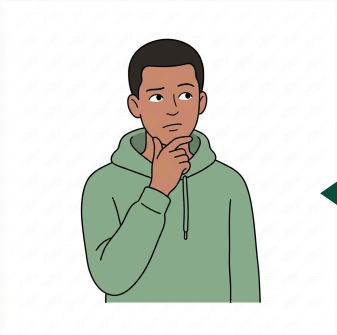
_____

_____

_____

UNIT 10 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

10 Plural Nouns — Regular (-s, -es) and Irregular (children, men, feet)



Sam

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Workplace Facilities & Welfare Provision Audit

★ B Pluralisation Rules: Regular Suffixes vs Irregular Roots

Plural nouns represent more than one person, place, or thing:

Regular: Noun + -s • **Hissing Sounds (-ch, -sh, -s, -x, -z):** Noun + -es • **Irregular:** Root Vowel Shift

- **Standard Rule (-s):** *desk → desks, tool → tools, computer → computers.*
- **The -es Rule:** When a singular noun ends in *-s, -ss, -sh, -ch*, or *-x*, add **-es** to create a pronounceable syllable (e.g. *box → boxes, branch → branches, bus → buses*).
- **Top Irregular Plurals:** Never add -s to nouns that change their root vowels or forms: *man → men, woman → women, child → children, foot → feet, tooth → teeth, person → people.*
- **No Apostrophe for Plurals:** Never use an apostrophe to form a simple plural (e.g. *"apple's for sale"* is WRONG; write *"apples"*).

× Common Mistake

All fire boxs must be checked by the two security mans and their childs.

✓ Correct Sentence

All fire boxes must be checked by the two security men and their children.

Why: Added -es to 'box' ('boxes') and replaced incorrect pluralisations 'mans' and 'childs' with proper irregular forms 'men' and 'children'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 What is the correct plural form of the word *'bench'*?

☐ benchs ☐ benches ☐ bench's

2 Select the correct plural form of *'woman'*:

☐ womans ☐ women ☐ womens

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Form the plural of 'tax' and 'glass']:** *The company pays several [tax] and ordered fifty [glass]*

4 **[Correct the irregular plural error]:** *Several persons and their childs attended the family open day*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 10.

UNIT 11 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

11 Plural Nouns ending in -y to -ies vs vowel+y



Abdul

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Corporate Compliance & Human Resources Directives

★ B The Consonant-Y vs Vowel-Y Orthographic Rule

Look at the letter immediately before the final 'y' to determine the plural spelling:

[Consonant + Y] → **Drop 'y', add** -IES **(e.g. factory → factor ies)**

[Vowel + Y] → **Keep 'y', add** -S **(e.g. day → day s)**

- **Consonant + Y:** *company → companies, policy → policies, delivery → deliveries, category → categories, facility → facilities.*
- **Vowel + Y (a, e, i, o, u + y):** *delay → delays, journey → journeys, key → keys, holiday → holidays, display → displays.*
- **Common Pitfall:** Never write *delaiyes* or *companys*. Check the preceding letter every single time!

× Common Mistake

All local deliverys were postponed because both companys updated their internal policys.

✓ Correct Sentence

All local deliveries were postponed because both companies updated their internal policies.

Why: Since 'delivery', 'company', and 'policy' each end in a consonant + y (r-y, n-y, c-y), the 'y' changes to '-ies'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 What is the correct plural form of *'company'*?

☐ companys ☐ companies ☐ company's

2 Choose the correct plural form of *'holiday'*:

☐ holidays ☐ holidies ☐ holiday's

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

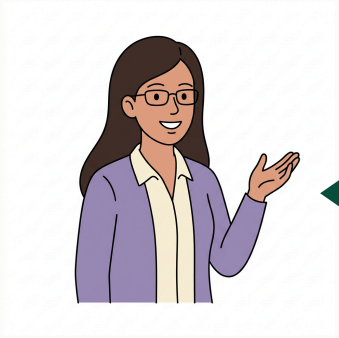
3 **[Change to plural: factory / facility]:** *The town contains three large [factory] and two training [facility]*

4 **[Change to plural: journey / tray]:** *The drivers recorded all daily [journey] and stacked the wooden [tray]*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 11.

UNIT 12 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

12 Apostrophes with Regular Plural Nouns (The managers' meeting)



Priya

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Executive Boardroom & Staff Noticeboard

B Plural Possession Architecture: Regular Plurals Ending in -s Take Only an Apostrophe

When showing that a PLURAL group ending in -s owns something, place the apostrophe AFTER the -s:

[Plural Owners Ending in -s] + **'** **(apostrophe only)** + **[Item / Event Owned]**

- **Regular Plural Ownership:** *the managers' meeting* (meeting of multiple managers), *the drivers' rest room* (room for all drivers), *the teachers' staff room.*
- **Singular vs Plural Contrast:**
  - *The worker's lunch* = belonging to ONE worker.
  - *The workers' lockers* = belonging to MANY workers.
- **Irregular Plurals (men, women, children, people):** Because they do NOT end in -s, treat them like singular nouns: add **'s** (e.g. *the children's ward, the women's changing room, the people's choice*).

× Common Mistake

The supervisor inspected the driver's rest area and the apprentice's toolboxes.

✓ Correct Sentence

The supervisor inspected the drivers' rest area and the apprentices' toolboxes.

Why: Moved the apostrophe to after the 's' ('drivers'', 'apprentices'') because multiple drivers share the rest area and multiple apprentices own the toolboxes.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which phrase correctly describes a briefing for multiple supervisors?

- ☐ the supervisor's briefing
- ☐ the supervisors' briefing
- ☐ the supervisors briefing's

2 Choose the correct punctuation for a cloakroom used by many nurses:

- ☐ the nurses' cloakroom
- ☐ the nurse's cloakroom
- ☐ the nurses cloakroom's

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Make plural possessive: the changing room for teachers]:** *the changing room of the teachers*

4 **[Make plural possessive: the union of workers]:** *the union belonging to all workers*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 12.

UNIT 13 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

13 Present Simple Tense for Daily Routines & Shift Handover



Marcus

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Daily Operating Routines & Duty Rota

B Present Simple Architecture: Habitual Routine & Third-Person Suffix

Use the present simple for routines, schedules, and permanent facts:

[I / You / We / They] + **[Base Verb]** **(e.g. inspect, clean)** • **[He / She / It / Singular Noun]** + **[Base Verb + -s / -es]**

- **First Person / Plural:** *"We record temperatures every hour; they sanitize the surfaces."*
- **Third Person Singular:** Always add **-s** or **-es** for singular subjects (e.g. *"The nurse administer**s** medication; the supervisor inspect**s** the fire doors."*).
- **Verbs ending in -ch, -sh, -s, -o:** Add **-es** (e.g. *he watches, she washes, the motor passes, he does, she goes*).

× Common Mistake

Every morning, the care assistant empty the laundry bin and check the call alarms.

✓ Correct Sentence

Every morning, the care assistant empties the laundry bin and checks the call alarms.

Why: Added third-person singular endings ('empties', 'checks') to match the singular subject 'the care assistant'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence uses the correct present simple verb for a daily routine?

- ☐ The caretaker unlocks the main gates at 07:00 every day.
- ☐ The caretaker unlock the main gates at 07:00 every day.
- ☐ The caretaker unlocking the main gates at 07:00 every day.

2 Choose the correct verb form for a plural subject: *'Both apprentices [_____] the warehouse inventory every afternoon.'*

☐ updates ☐ update ☐ updated

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

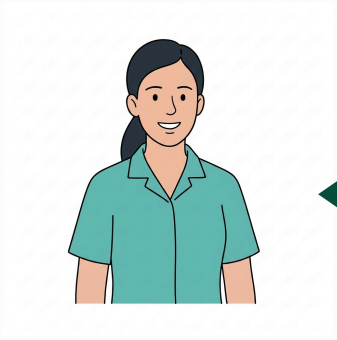
3 **[Apply third-person singular -s]:** *The supervisor [inspect] the safety log every Friday*

4 **[Apply third-person singular -es]:** *The technician [wash] his hands and [go] to the staff room*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 13.

UNIT 14 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

14 Present Continuous for Current Tasks ('is working')



Sarah

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Live IT Helpdesk & Live Incident Dispatch

B Present Continuous Architecture: Auxiliary (be) + Present Participle (-ing)

Form the present continuous using the auxiliary verb 'to be' plus the base verb ending in '-ing':

[Subject] + **[am / is / are]** + **[Base Verb + -ing]**

- **I → am:** *"I am updating the network security credentials now."*
- **He / She / It / Singular Noun → is:** *"The engineer is replacing the router; software is downloading."*
- **We / You / They / Plural Noun → are:** *"Technicians are testing the fiber-optic cable connection."*
- **Spelling Rules for -ing:**
  - Drop silent 'e': *configure → configuring, write → writing.*
  - Double consonant after single short vowel: *run → running, stop → stopping.*

× Common Mistake

Currently, the IT technician updating the server and two engineers is running diagnostic tests.

✓ Correct Sentence

Currently, the IT technician is updating the server and two engineers are running diagnostic tests.

Why: Supplied the missing auxiliary 'is' for the singular technician and corrected 'is' to 'are' for the plural engineers.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence forms the present continuous tense correctly?

- ☐ The electrician currently rewiring the main circuit breaker.
- ☐ The electrician is currently rewiring the main circuit breaker.
- ☐ The electrician are currently rewiring the main circuit breaker.

2 Choose the correct auxiliary verb: *'At this moment, our team [_____] reviewing the security logs.'*

☐ is ☐ are ☐ am

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

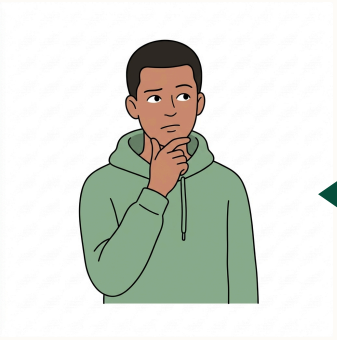
3 **[Add the missing auxiliary verb]:** *The network administrator [install] security patches at present*

4 **[Apply spelling rule: double consonant]:** *The database backup is [stop] due to a connection error*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 14.

UNIT 15 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

15 Past Simple — Regular Verbs with -ed Spelling Rules



Sam

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Accident Log & HSE Official Investigation

★ B Past Simple Regular Suffixes: -ed Spelling Mechanics

Add -ed to the base form of regular verbs to describe completed past actions:

Regular: Verb + -ed • **Ends in -e:** Verb + -d • **Consonant-Vowel-Consonant (CVC):** Double Final Letter + -ed • **Consonant + y:** Change to -ied

- **Standard Addition:** *inspect → inspected, check → checked, report → reported, clean → cleaned.*
- **Ends in Silent -e:** Add only **-d** (e.g. *arrive → arrived, close → closed, operate → operated*).
- **1-Syllable Short Vowel (CVC):** Double final consonant (e.g. *slip → slipped, stop → stopped, plan → planned, drop → dropped*).
- **Consonant + y:** Change 'y' to 'i' and add -ed (e.g. *carry → carried, tidy → tidied, rely → relied*).

× Common Mistake

Yesterday, the worker sliped on the wet floor, so we stoped the line and carryed him to medical.

✓ Correct Sentence

Yesterday, the worker slipped on the wet floor, so we stopped the line and carried him to medical.

Why: Doubled final consonants for 'slipped' and 'stopped' (CVC rule), and changed 'y' to 'i' in 'carried'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 What is the correct past simple spelling of *'slip'*?

☐ sliped ☐ slipped ☐ slipt

2 What is the correct past simple spelling of *'carry'*?

☐ carryed ☐ carried ☐ carred

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Apply past simple CVC doubling rule]:** *The forklift driver [stop] immediately and [drop] the pallet*

4 **[Apply past simple consonant + y rule]:** *The warehouse apprentice [tidy] the shelving and [empty] the bins*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 15.

UNIT 16 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

16 Past Simple — Top 40 Irregular Verbs (went, saw, took, wrote, came)



Abdul

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Security Log & Formal Witness Statement

★ B Irregular Past Morphology: Root Changes (No -ed)

Irregular verbs completely change their form in the past simple:

go → went • **see → saw** • **take → took** • **write → wrote** • **come → came**

- **Top Workplace Irregular Past Forms:**
  - *give → gave, tell → told, find → found, make → made, buy → bought.*
  - *leave → left, hear → heard, speak → spoke, break → broke, bring → brought.*
  - *meet → met, understand → understood, know → knew, spend → spent, send → sent.*
- **Fatal Non-Standard Pitfalls:** Never use *seen* for *saw* without 'have/had' (say: *"I saw the intruder"* NOT *"I seen the intruder"*). Never say *"He done it"* (say: *"He did it"*).

× Common Mistake

Yesterday, I seen the broken lock and writed an incident report before the manager come in.

✓ Correct Sentence

Yesterday, I saw the broken lock and wrote an incident report before the manager came in.

Why: Replaced non-standard 'seen' with 'saw', 'writed' with 'wrote', and present tense 'come' with past tense 'came'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which option is the correct past simple form of the verb *'write'*?

☐ writed ☐ wrote ☐ written

2 Choose the correct Standard English past form: *'The security guard [_____] the broken padlock on the gate.'*

☐ seen ☐ seed ☐ saw

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

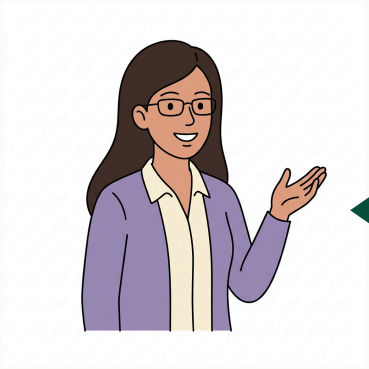
3 **[Convert present to past simple]:** *The manager [tell] us about the inspection and [give] instructions*

4 **[Convert present to past simple]:** *I [see] the intruder and [speak] to security immediately*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 16.

UNIT 17 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

17 Future Intentions — 'Going to' vs 'Will' in Planning



Priya

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Client Project Schedule & Team Resource Plan

B Future Form Architecture: Planned Intentions vs Promises / Spontaneous Decisions

Select your future tense construction based on whether the action was pre-planned:

[Be + Going to + Verb] → **Prior Decision / Planned Intention** • **[Will + Verb]** → **Instant Decision / Firm Promise**

- **'Going to' for Pre-Planned Intentions:** *"The management team is going to review departmental budgets next month."* (Decided beforehand).
- **'Will' for Spontaneous Decisions & Offers:** *"The phone is ringing; I will answer it."*
- **'Will' for Formal Promises & Guarantees:** *"We will deliver your furniture by Friday at 17:00."*
- **Grammatical Trap:** Never omit the auxiliary verb with 'going to' (do not say: *"We going to inspect"*; write: *"We are going to inspect"*).

× Common Mistake

Next week, the contractor going to install new windows and we will definitely completed on time.

✓ Correct Sentence

Next week, the contractor is going to install new windows, and we will definitely complete the project on time.

Why: Inserted missing auxiliary 'is' before 'going to' and corrected 'completed' to base verb 'complete' after modal 'will'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence expresses a planned future intention with correct grammar?

- ☐ We going to launch the new company website in March.
- ☐ We are going to launch the new company website in March.
- ☐ We will to launch the new company website in March.

2 Choose the correct verb following the modal 'will': *'Our logistics partner will [_____] the shipment on Thursday.'*

☐ dispatch ☐ dispatched ☐ dispatching

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Insert the missing auxiliary for 'going to']:** *Next Monday, our company [going to] upgrade its payment terminals*

4 **[Use 'will' + base verb for a client promise]:** *Apex Solutions [guarantee] delivery within forty-eight hours*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 17.

UNIT 18 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

18 Subject-Verb Agreement — Singular vs Plural (is/are, was/were)



Marcus

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Formal Disciplinary & Incident Record

★ B Subject-Verb Concord: Matching Number and Person

A singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb:

[Singular Subject] → **is / was / has / does** • **[Plural Subject]** → **are / were / have / do**

- **Present Tense:** *"The manager is satisfied; the employees are ready."*
- **Past Tense:** *"The apprentice was punctual; the technicians were delayed."*
- **Intervening Prepositional Phrases:** Words between the subject and verb do not change the subject's number (e.g. *"The box [of spare fuses]* ***is*** *heavy"* — 'box' is singular!).
- **Compound Subjects Joined by 'and':** Take a plural verb (e.g. *"David and Emma* ***were*** *present at the hearing."*).

× Common Mistake
Both witnesses was interviewed by the panel, but the supervisor were absent.

✓ Correct Sentence
Both witnesses were interviewed by the panel, but the supervisor was absent.

Why: Changed 'was' to plural 'were' to match 'both witnesses', and 'were' to singular 'was' to match 'the supervisor'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the correct verb for subject-verb agreement: *'The quality manager [_____] reviewing the shift report.'*

☐ is ☐ are ☐ were

2 Select the correct past tense verb: *'All four delivery drivers [_____] trained on the new tail-lift.'*

☐ was ☐ were ☐ is

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

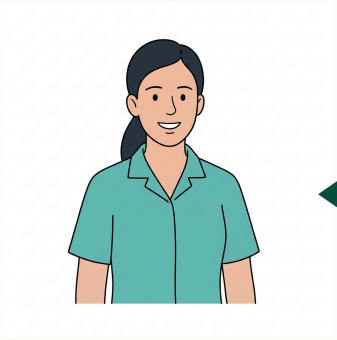
3 **[Choose between was and were]:** *Both security cameras [was / were] disabled during the power surge*

4 **[Choose between is and are]:** *The list of approved suppliers [is / are] pinned to the staff noticeboard*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 18.

UNIT 19 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

19 Subject-Verb Agreement with There is / There are



Sarah

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Inventory Audit & Stock Discrepancy Bulletin

★ B Existential Agreement: The True Subject Follows the Verb

In sentences opening with 'There is' or 'There are', the word 'There' is merely a placeholder; the verb matches the noun that follows:

There is / There was + **[Singular Noun / Uncountable Noun]** • **There are / There were** + **[Plural Noun]**

- **Singular / Uncountable:** *"There is a severe leak in Bay 2; there is water on the floor."*
- **Plural:** *"There are forty parcels waiting in the holding area; there were three discrepancies."*
- **Spoken English Trap:** In casual speech, people frequently contract 'There's' for plurals (e.g. *"There's three boxes"*). In Functional Skills Level 1 writing, this is an agreement error. You MUST write: *"There are three boxes."*

× Common Mistake

There is fifty damaged cartons in Bay 1 and there was no forklift drivers available.

✓ Correct Sentence

There are fifty damaged cartons in Bay 1 and there were no forklift drivers available.

Why: Changed 'there is' to 'there are' (matching plural 'fifty cartons') and 'there was' to 'there were' (matching plural 'drivers').

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the correct present tense form: *'[_____] several safety hazards identified in the machine shop.'*

☐ There is ☐ There are ☐ There's

2 Choose the correct past tense form: *'[_____] a significant discrepancy in yesterday's stock count.'*

☐ There were ☐ There was ☐ There are

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

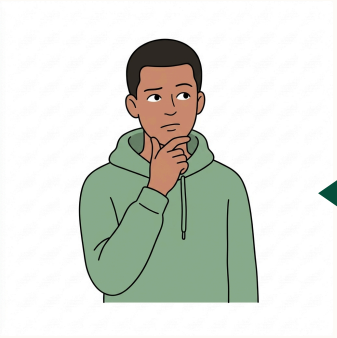
3 **[Choose between There is and There are]:** *[There is / There are] six replacement air filters on Shelf B*

4 **[Choose between There was and There were]:** *[There was / There were] only one fire extinguisher in the corridor*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 19.

UNIT 20 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

20 Pronoun Consistency — Avoiding Switching between You, I, and They



Sam

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Employee Health & Wellbeing Information Leaflet

★ B Point of View Consistency Architecture: Maintain Perspective

Choose your point of view and maintain it throughout the entire paragraph:

First Person (I / We): **Personal reflection, direct organizational reports** • **Second Person (You):** **Direct instructional guidance** • **Third Person (They / Employees):** **Objective policy**

- **Second Person (Instructional):** *"When **you** enter the clean room, **you** must wash **your** hands."*
- **Third Person (General Policy):** *"When **employees** enter the clean room, **they** must wash **their** hands."*
- **Unintended Pronoun Shift Pitfall:** *"If an employee feels unwell, **you** should inform **your** manager."* → Fix: *"If an employee feels unwell, **they** should inform **their** manager."*

× Common Mistake

When a worker arrives on site, you must sign in so that we can track your attendance.

✓ Correct Sentence

When workers arrive on site, they must sign in so that supervisors can track their attendance.

Why: Eliminated the confusing shift from third person ('a worker') to second person ('you/your'), creating consistent third-person perspective.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence maintains consistent second-person pronouns throughout?

- ☐ When you join the gym, employees must complete a health form.
- ☐ When you join the gym, you must complete a health form.
- ☐ When you join the gym, we must complete a health form.

2 Choose the option that maintains consistent third-person plural pronouns:

- ☐ If candidates pass the exam, you will receive a certificate.
- ☐ If candidates pass the exam, they will receive their certificates.
- ☐ If candidates pass the exam, he will receive your certificate.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Correct pronoun shift to second person]:** *When a worker lifts a heavy box, you must bend your knees*

4 **[Correct pronoun shift to third person]:** *If an apprentice needs advice, you should consult your mentor*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 20.

UNIT 21 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

21 Standard English vs Informal Slang (Done vs Did, Seen vs Saw)



Abdul

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Formal Customer Complaint & Legal Rectification Letter

B Standard English Architecture: High Register vs Colloquial Speech

Standard English is the universally accepted formal dialect of business and academia:

Non-Standard / Slang: **done it • seen it • would of • gonna • ain't • innit**

Standard English: **did it • saw it • would have • going to • is not**

- **Did vs Done:** *"I **did** the stock check"* (Simple past) vs *"I **have done** the stock check"* (With helper 'have'). Never say *"I done it"*.
- **Saw vs Seen:** *"We **saw** the problem"* (Simple past) vs *"We **have seen** the problem"*. Never say *"We seen it"*.
- **Would have (NOT 'would of'):** *"The engineer **would have** fixed the machine if parts were available."*
- **Double Negatives:** Never use double negatives (e.g. *"We haven't got no stock"* → *"We do not have any stock"*).

× Common Mistake

We seen the leak and done what we could, but we couldn't do nothing because we ain't got no tools.

✓ Correct Sentence

We saw the leak and did what we could, but we could not do anything because we did not have any tools.

Why: Replaced non-standard 'seen' with 'saw', 'done' with 'did', and eradicated both double negatives ('couldn't do nothing' and 'ain't got no').

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the sentence written in correct Standard English:

- [ ] I seen the delivery lorry arrive at noon.
- [ ] I saw the delivery lorry arrive at noon.
- [ ] I done saw the delivery lorry arrive at noon.

2 Identify the correct form of the helper verb construction:

- [ ] The manager would of approved the overtime.
- [ ] The manager would have approved the overtime.
- [ ] The manager would off approved the overtime.

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

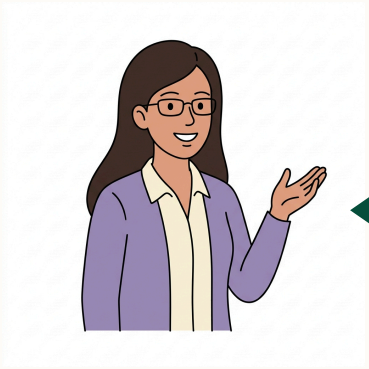
3 **[Replace non-standard 'done' with 'did']:** *The technician done all the electrical tests this morning*

4 **[Replace 'would of' with 'would have']:** *Our team would of completed the order if the power stayed on*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 21.

UNIT 22 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

22 Homophones Set 1 — Their, There, They're



Priya

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Office Relocation & Workspace Allocation Notice

★ B The Big Three Homophones: Possession, Place & Contraction

Master the three distinct meanings and orthographies:

THEIR = Belongs to them (Possession: 'HEIR' owns property) • THERE = A location / Place (Contains 'HERE') • THEY'RE = They are (Contraction: apostrophe replaces 'a')

- **THEIR (Possessive):** *"All employees must collect **their** new security passes."*
- **THERE (Place / Existence):** *"Please stack the crates over **there**; **there** are forty chairs."*
- **THEY'RE (They Are):** *"**They're** going to finish painting the conference room before noon."*

× Common Mistake

The managers parked there cars over their because they're permits was expired.

✓ Correct Sentence

The managers parked their cars over there because their permits were expired.

Why: Corrected 'there cars' to possessive 'their', 'over their' to location 'there', and 'they're permits' to possessive 'their'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the correct homophone: *'The contractors left [_____] toolkits in the basement.'*

☐ there ☐ their ☐ they're

2 Choose the correct homophone: *'Please place the new first aid box over [_____].'*

☐ their ☐ there ☐ they're

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Insert their, there, or they're]:** *All technicians must bring [_____] safety certificates*

4 **[Insert their, there, or they're]:** *[_____] are six meeting rooms available on Floor 2*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 22.

UNIT 23 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

23 Homophones Set 2 — Two, To, Too



Marcus

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Trade Quotation & Client Scope of Work

★ B Number, Direction & Excess Mechanics

Distinguish the number, the preposition, and the adverb:

TWO = The Number 2 • TO = Direction / Preposition / Infinitive Verb • TOO = Also / As well / Excessively (Extra 'O' = Extra amount!)

- **TWO (Number 2):** *"The quotation includes **two** replacement industrial boilers."*
- **TO (Direction / Action):** *"Send the invoice **to** accounts; we need **to** order parts."*
- **TOO (Excessive / Also):** *"The crane is **too** heavy for the bridge; the apprentice wants to attend **too**."*

× Common Mistake

We sent to apprentices too the warehouse, but the crate was to heavy to lift.

✓ Correct Sentence

We sent two apprentices to the warehouse, but the crate was too heavy to lift.

Why: Corrected 'to apprentices' to number 'two', 'too the warehouse' to direction 'to', and 'to heavy' to excessive 'too'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the correct word for the number 2: *'The contractor submitted [_____] separate bids.'*

☐ to ☐ too ☐ two

2 Choose the correct word meaning 'also': *'Marcus completed the safety test, and Elena passed it [_____].'*

☐ to ☐ too ☐ two

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

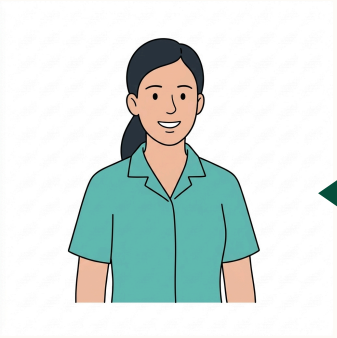
3 **[Insert to, too, or two]:** *The pallet is [_____] wide to fit through the doorway*

4 **[Insert to, too, or two]:** *Please deliver these documents [_____] the accounts department*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 23.

UNIT 24 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

24 Homophones Set 3 — Hear/Here, Wear/Where, New/Knew



Sarah

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Factory Workshop Noticeboard & PPE Directive

★ B Sensory & Spatial Homophones: Orthographic Anchors

Pair each homophone with its visual memory anchor:

HEAR (Listen with your EAR) vs HERE (This place) • WEAR (Clothing/PPE) vs WHERE (Location question) • NEW (Fresh/Recent) vs KNEW (Past of 'know')

- **HEAR vs HERE:** *"Can you **hear** the fire alarm over **here**?"* (Hear has an 'EAR' inside it).
- **WEAR vs WHERE:** *"You must **wear** eye goggles **where** machinery is operating."*
- **NEW vs KNEW:** *"The apprentice **knew** how to operate the **new** laser cutter."* (Knew has a silent 'K' like knowledge).

× Common Mistake

Sign here if you can't here the siren, and check wear you should where your ear defenders.

✓ Correct Sentence

Sign here if you can't hear the siren, and check where you should wear your ear defenders.

Why: Corrected 'here the siren' to 'hear' (auditory) and flipped 'wear/where' so that 'where' indicates location and 'wear' indicates putting on clothing.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Choose the correct word: *'Please register your attendance [_____] at reception.'*

☐ hear ☐ here ☐ heare

2 Choose the correct word: *'All machine operators must [_____] protective boots.'*

☐ where ☐ ware ☐ wear

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Choose between hear and here]:** *Stand [_____] so that you can [_____] the supervisor's briefing*

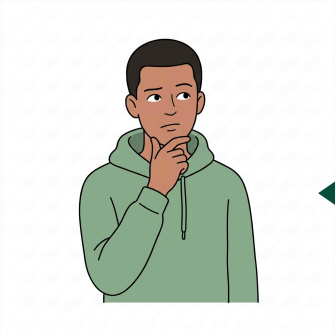
4 **[Choose between wear and where]:** *Do you know [_____] staff must [_____] high-visibility vests?*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 24.

25

UNIT 25 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

Prefixes — Un-, Dis-, Mis-, Re-



Sam

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Quality Control & Manufacturing Defect Log

★ B Prefix Mechanics: Modifying Root Words Without Altering Base Spelling

A prefix attaches to the front of a base root word without changing the root's spelling:

UN- = **Not / Reverse** • **DIS-** = **Opposite / Away** • **MIS-** = **Badly / Wrongly** • **RE-** = **Again / Back**

- **UN- (Not / Undo):** *unsafe, unpack, unclear, unauthorized, unlocked.*
- **DIS- (Opposite):** *disconnect, disinfect, disagree, disable, disappear.*
- **MIS- (Wrongly / Inaccurately):** *misread, miscalculate, misplace, misunderstand, mislabel.* (Notice: *mis + spell = misspell* with double 's'!).
- **RE- (Again):** *rebuild, reload, retest, restart, refund, replace.*
- **The Golden Spelling Rule:** Simply glue the prefix directly onto the unchanged root word: *un + happy = unhappy*; *dis + satisfied = dissatisfied* (keep both 's's!).

× Common Mistake

The technician dissconnected the cable because the container was misslabelled and uncomplete.

✓ Correct Sentence

The technician disconnected the cable because the container was mislabelled and incomplete.

Why: Corrected 'dissconnected' (dis + connect has only one 's'), 'misslabelled' (mis + label has only one 's'), and replaced 'uncomplete' with proper 'incomplete'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which prefix creates a word meaning *'to calculate incorrectly'*?

☐ un- ☐ dis- ☐ mis-

2 What is the correct spelling when attaching the prefix *'dis-'* to *'satisfied'*?

☐ disatisfied ☐ dissatisfied ☐ dissatsfied

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Add 'mis-' to 'place']:** *Be careful not to [mis + place] the security swipe card*

4 **[Add 'dis-' to 'connect']:** *Always [dis + connect] the appliance before maintenance*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 25.

UNIT 26 • CORE FOUNDATIONS

26 Suffixes — -ful, -less, -ly, -ment



Abdul

A The Concept in Everyday Use: Staff Appraisal & Employment Reference

★ B Suffix Mechanics: -ful, -less, -ly, -ment

Suffixes attach to the ends of words to change their grammatical function:

-FUL = Full of (Always ONE 'l'!) • -LESS = Without (Always TWO 's's!) • -LY = Adverb (How something is done) • -MENT = State or result of action

- **The -FUL Rule:** The suffix *-ful* has ONLY ONE 'L': *careful, helpful, successful, grateful, stressful.* Never spell it with -full!
- **The -LESS Rule:** *careless, spotless, endless, painless.*
- **The -LY Rule:** Turns adjectives into adverbs: *quick → quickly, polite → politely, careful → carefully* (notice: *careful + ly = carefully* with two 'l's!).
- **The -MENT Rule:** Creates nouns from verbs: *develop → development, manage → management, equip → equipment.* Keep the silent 'e' in most cases!

× Common Mistake

Marcus is a carefull worker who completes every assignement quickley and shows great managment.

✓ Correct Sentence

Marcus is a careful worker who completes every assignment quickly and shows great management.

Why: Corrected 'carefull' to single 'l' (-ful), fixed spelling of 'assignment' and 'quickly', and restored silent 'e' in 'management'.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which word is spelled correctly with the suffix *'-ful'*?

- ☐ successfull
- ☐ successful
- ☐ succesful

2 How do you form the adverb from the adjective *'careful'*?

- ☐ carefully
- ☐ carefuly
- ☐ carefullly

B Rewrite each sentence correctly

3 **[Add -ful to 'skill']:** *David is a [skill + ful] carpenter*

4 **[Add -ly to 'prompt']:** *The IT desk resolved our enquiry [prompt + ly]*

C Applied Practice: Write two sentences of your own using the rules from Unit 26.

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 1: Professional Workplace Register & Formal vs Informal Word Choice

In workplace writing, tone establishes your professionalism. Informal spoken idioms (e.g. 'kids', 'boss', 'get in touch') should be upgraded to precise vocational terminology. Using standard formal register ensures clarity and respect.



tell off / have a word → reprimand / address

The manager addressed the punctuality issue privately.



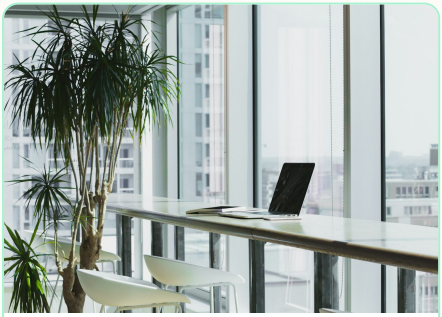
ask for → request / enquire

Please request replacement safety boots using Form B.



get in touch with → contact / liaise with

We will liaise with the regional logistics coordinator.



boss / gaffer → supervisor / line manager

Submit your annual leave form to your line manager.



look into → investigate / examine

Quality assurance will investigate the packaging defect.



put off → postpone / reschedule

The maintenance shutdown has been rescheduled for July.

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 1 • Applied Vocational Drills

Practise using these key words in everyday and work situations.

1 **Vocabulary Drill:** Transform the informal sentence into professional workplace English:
'Hi boss, I'm writing to tell you that I wanna put off our chat because I gotta look into a problem with the delivery van.'

2 Write a workplace sentence demonstrating correct usage of **reprimand / address**.

3 Write a message to a colleague using at least two formal words from Module 1.

✎ Word Study & Spelling Memory Box for Module 1

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 2: Essential Health, Safety & Compliance Vocabulary Bank

Health and Safety Executive (HSE) compliance requires exact vocabulary. Using vague language like 'dangerous stuff' instead of 'hazardous substances' weakens incident reports and legal documentation.



Hazard (/ˈhæzəd/) → A potential source of harm or adverse health effect.

Trailing electrical



Risk (/rɪsk/) → The likelihood and severity of harm occurring.

Conduct a risk assessment before operating the angle grinder.

Mandatory (/ˈmændətəri/) → Compulsory by law or official statutory directive.

photo coming soon

Mandatory (/ˈmændətəri/) → Compulsory by law or official statutory directive.

Wearing high-visibility

ˌvækjuˈeɪʃn/) → The urgent removal of personnel from a danger zone.

photo coming soon

Evacuation (/ɪ ˌvækjuˈeɪʃn/) → The urgent removal of personnel from a danger zone.

Follow the marked

ˈkɔːʃn/) → A preventative measure taken in advance to prevent danger.

photo coming soon

Precaution (/prɪ ˈkɔːʃn/) → A preventative measure taken in advance to prevent danger.

Take the precaution of

Flammable (/ˈflæməbl/) → Easily set on fire; combustible.

photo coming soon

Flammable (/ˈflæməbl/) → Easily set on fire; combustible.

Store flammable solvents inside the

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 2 • Applied Vocational Drills

Practise using these key words in everyday and work situations.

1 **Vocabulary Drill:** Complete the statutory safety instruction using words from the table:
'Workers must put on their gear because stuff can catch fire.'

2 Write a workplace sentence demonstrating correct usage of **A potential source of harm or adverse health effect.**.

3 Write a message to a colleague using at least two formal words from Module 2.

✎ Word Study & Spelling Memory Box for Module 2

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 3: Administrative & Office Communication Collocations

Collocations are pairs or groups of words that naturally co-occur in British business English. Using natural collocations (e.g. 'schedule an appointment', NOT 'make an appointment on calendar') makes administrative documents sound natural and authoritative.

schedule an appointment → Arrange a formal meeting or consultation.

photo coming soon

schedule an appointment → Arrange a formal meeting or consultation.

The receptionist scheduled an

submit an invoice → Send a bill for payment to accounts.

photo coming soon

submit an invoice → Send a bill for payment to accounts.

Please submit your monthly invoice by the

confirm attendance → Verify that you will participate.

photo coming soon

confirm attendance → Verify that you will participate.

Delegates must confirm their attendance by replying

attach documentation → Include supporting evidence or forms.

photo coming soon

attach documentation → Include supporting evidence or forms.

Remember to attach

resolve a discrepancy → Find a solution to an error or difference.

photo coming soon

resolve a discrepancy → Find a solution to an error or difference.

The warehouse manager resolved the

meet a deadline → Finish a task before the required time.

photo coming soon

meet a deadline → Finish a task before the required time.

The design department worked late to meet the printing deadline.

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 3 • Applied Vocational Drills

Practise using these key words in everyday and work situations.

1 **Vocabulary Drill:** Rewrite this clumsy sentence using standard office collocations:
'I am sending this letter for my manager to fix the difference in the bill before the end date.'

2 Write a workplace sentence demonstrating correct usage of **Arrange a formal meeting or consultation.**.

3 Write a message to a colleague using at least two formal words from Module 3.

✎ Word Study & Spelling Memory Box for Module 3

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 4: Customer Service & Hospitality Precision Phrasing

In retail, customer service, and hospitality, words de-escalate tension and protect brand loyalty. Replacing defensive language with empathetic, solution-oriented phrasing resolves complaints smoothly.

That's not my fault / job. → Allow me to direct you to the team leader who handles this.

photo coming soon

That's not my fault / job. → Allow me to direct you to the team leader who handles this.

Taking ownership of

→ Under our store policy, we are able to offer an exchange or credit note.

photo coming soon

You can't do that. → Under our store policy, we are able to offer an exchange or credit note.

You have to wait. → Thank you for your patience while I retrieve your account file.

photo coming soon

You have to wait. → Thank you for your patience while I retrieve your account file.

Showing courteous

understand your frustration, and I am committed to resolving this for you.

photo coming soon

Calm down. → I understand your frustration, and I am committed to resolving this for you.

De-escalating

none left. → Regrettably, that item is currently out of stock; I can order it for tomorrow.

photo coming soon

We don't have none left. → Regrettably, that item is currently out of stock; I can order it for tomorrow.

rules. → To ensure safety compliance, guests are requested to use the marked walkway.

photo coming soon

You broke the rules. → To ensure safety compliance, guests are requested to use the marked

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 4 • Applied Vocational Drills

Practise using these key words in everyday and work situations.

1 **Vocabulary Drill:** Rewrite the blunt customer service reply into courteous, professional correspondence:
'You can't have a refund because you lost the receipt and it's not my problem.'

2 Write a workplace sentence demonstrating correct usage of **Allow me to direct you to the team leader who handles this.**.

3 Write a message to a colleague using at least two formal words from Module 4.

✎ Word Study & Spelling Memory Box for Module 4

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 5: Master Spelling Rules & Morphological Patterns

English spelling follows consistent structural patterns. Mastering these five fundamental rules eliminates over 80% of common Functional Skills Level 1 spelling errors.

ends in Consonant-Vowel-Consonant, double the final consonant before adding a vowel suffix (-ed, -ing, -er).

1. CVC Consonant Doubling

photo coming soon

When a 1-syllable word ends in Consonant-

silent 'e' when adding a suffix starting with a vowel (-ing, -ed, -able). Keep it before consonant suffixes (-ful, -ment).

2. Drop Silent 'e' Before Vowel →

photo coming soon

Drop the final silent 'e' when adding a suffix starting with a vowel (-ing, -ed,

ends in a consonant + 'y', change 'y' to 'i' before suffixes (-ed, -es, -ly, -ness), UNLESS adding -ing.

3. Change 'y' to 'i' →

photo coming soon

When a word ends in a consonant + 'y', change 'y' to 'i' before suffixes (-ed, -es, -ly, -

Except After 'C' → Spell 'ie' when the sound is long /ee/, except immediately after the letter 'c'.

4. 'I' Before 'E' Except After 'C' →

photo coming soon

Spell 'ie' when the sound is long /ee/, except immediately after the letter

5. Plural of -f / -fe to -ves → Nouns ending in -f or -fe change to -ves in the plural.

5. Plural of -f / -fe to -ves →

photo coming soon

Nouns ending in -f or -fe change to -ves in the plural.

shelf → shelves, knife

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 5 • Applied Vocational Drills

Practise using these key words in everyday and work situations.

1 **Vocabulary Drill:** Apply the correct spelling rules to form the derived words: *'rely + ed = ? | drop + ing = ? | receive or recieve? | shelf (plural) = ?'*

2 Write a workplace sentence demonstrating correct usage of **When a 1-syllable word ends in Consonant-Vowel-Consonant, double the final consonant before adding a vowel suffix (-ed, -ing, -er)..**

3 Write a message to a colleague using at least two formal words from Module 5.

✎ Word Study & Spelling Memory Box for Module 5

VOCABULARY IN USE • VISUAL DICTIONARY

Vocabulary Module 6: High-Frequency Level 1 Functional Spelling Bank

Examiners penalise repetitive spelling errors in high-frequency vocabulary. Memorise these core vocational words divided into practical semantic categories.

Administration → business, calendar, necessary, receipt, committee, separate

photo coming soon

Office Administration → business, calendar, necessary, receipt, committee,

hazardous, equipment, hygiene, accident, maintenance, ambulance

photo coming soon

Health & Safety → hazardous, equipment, hygiene, accident, maintenance, ambulance

Customer Service → apologise, quality, excellent, responsibility, dissatisfied

photo coming soon

Customer Service → apologise, quality, excellent, responsibility, dissatisfied

Time & Scheduling → Wednesday, February, tomorrow, today, autumn, schedule

photo coming soon

Time & Scheduling → Wednesday, February, tomorrow, today, autumn, schedule

Logistics → warehouse, packaging, colleague, vehicle, dispatch

photo coming soon

Facilities & Logistics → warehouse, packaging, colleague, vehicle, dispatch

'Colleague' ends like

→ successful, definitely, environment, opportunity, sincerely

photo coming soon

General Workplace → successful, definitely, environment, opportunity, sincerely

VOCABULARY IN USE • PRACTICE DRILLS

Module 6 • Applied Vocational Drills

Practise using these key words in everyday and work situations.

1 **Vocabulary Drill:** Select and write the correctly spelled words from each pair:
'neccessary / necessary | buisness / business | tomorow / tomorrow | definately / definitely'

2 Write a workplace sentence demonstrating correct usage of **business, calendar, necessary, receipt, committee, separate**.

3 Write a message to a colleague using at least two formal words from Module 6.

✎ Word Study & Spelling Memory Box for Module 6

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 1 TO 7: CAPITAL LETTERS, FULL STOPS, CONJUNCTIONS & COMMAS

1 Workout 1: Mixed Workout 1: Sentence Boundaries, Connectives & Commas

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 8 TO 12: CONTRACTIONS, SINGULAR & PLURAL POSSESSION, AND PLURAL NOUNS

2 Workout 2: Mixed Workout 2: Apostrophes, Plurals & Possession

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 13 TO 17: PRESENT SIMPLE, PRESENT CONTINUOUS, REGULAR & IRREGULAR PAST, FUTURE INTENTIONS

3

Workout 3: Mixed Workout 3: Tenses & Verb Consistency in Reports

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 18 TO 21: SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT, THERE IS/ARE, PRONOUN CONSISTENCY & STANDARD ENGLISH

4

Workout 4: Mixed Workout 4: Agreement, Pronoun Harmony & Standard English

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 22 TO 24: THEIR/THERE/THEY'RE, TWO/TO/TOO, HEAR/HERE, WEAR/WHERE, NEW/KNEW

5

Workout 5: Mixed Workout 5: Essential Workplace Homophones

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 25 & 26: PREFIXES (UN-, DIS-, MIS-, RE-) AND SUFFIXES (-FUL, -LESS, -LY, -MENT)

6 Workout 6: Mixed Workout 6: Prefixes, Suffixes & Word Formation

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 1 TO 7: CAPITAL LETTERS, FULL STOPS, CONJUNCTIONS & COMMAS

7

Workout 7: Mixed Workout 1: Sentence Boundaries, Connectives & Commas

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 8 TO 12: CONTRACTIONS, SINGULAR & PLURAL POSSESSION, AND PLURAL NOUNS

8 Workout 8: Mixed Workout 2: Apostrophes, Plurals & Possession

Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 13 TO 17: PRESENT SIMPLE, PRESENT CONTINUOUS, REGULAR & IRREGULAR PAST, FUTURE INTENTIONS

9

Workout 9: Mixed Workout 3: Tenses & Verb Consistency in Reports

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 18 TO 21: SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT, THERE IS/ARE, PRONOUN CONSISTENCY & STANDARD ENGLISH

10

Workout 10: Mixed Workout 4: Agreement, Pronoun Harmony & Standard English

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 22 TO 24: THEIR/THERE/THEY'RE, TWO/TO/TOO, HEAR/HERE, WEAR/WHERE, NEW/KNEW

11

Workout 11: Mixed Workout 5: Essential Workplace Homophones

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

PROOFREADING PRACTICE • UNITS 25 & 26: PREFIXES (UN-, DIS-, MIS-, RE-) AND SUFFIXES (-FUL, -LESS, -LY, -MENT)

12

Workout 12: Mixed Workout 6: Prefixes, Suffixes & Word Formation

▶ Everyday Document for Proofreading

	Error Found in Text	Correction & Rule
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ Key Learning Rule to Remember

M1

EXAM PRACTICE • 12 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Exam 1

Task: Official Exam Mock 1: Health & Safety Incident Investigation

Your Writing Task:

Level 1 Success Checklist

Plan your ideas in 2-3 short paragraphs before starting.

Common Slip

Check capital letters for 'I', names, and days of the week.

✎ Candidate Notes & Word Plan

OFFICIAL RULED RESPONSE PAGE

Mock Exam 1 • Candidate Response Booklet

✎ Write your response below:

M2

EXAM PRACTICE • 12 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Exam 2

Task: Official Exam Mock 2: Customer Service Complaint Resolution

Your Writing Task:

Level 1 Success Checklist

Plan your ideas in 2-3 short paragraphs before starting.

Common Slip

Check capital letters for 'I', names, and days of the week.

✎ Candidate Notes & Word Plan

OFFICIAL RULED RESPONSE PAGE

Mock Exam 2 • Candidate Response Booklet

✎ Write your response below:

M3

EXAM PRACTICE • 12 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Exam 3

Task: Official Exam Mock 3: Workplace Policy & Staff Briefing Memo

Your Writing Task:

Level 1 Success Checklist

Plan your ideas in 2-3 short paragraphs before starting.

Common Slip

Check capital letters for 'I', names, and days of the week.

✎ Candidate Notes & Word Plan

OFFICIAL RULED RESPONSE PAGE

Mock Exam 3 • Candidate Response Booklet

✎ Write your response below:

SPAG LEVEL 1 REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX

Worked Solutions, Glossary & Index

DIAGNOSTIC ASSESSMENT WORKED SOLUTIONS (QUESTIONS 1–10)

Q11. B (Capitalised 'The', ends with full stop '.')

Q22. B (Full stop splits two distinct independent thoughts into separate sentences)

Q33. A (Polite enquiry starting with auxiliary 'Could' requires a question mark '?')

Q44. A (Urgent hazard warning requires single exclamation mark '!')

Q55. B (Tuesday, October, City Hospital are all proper nouns requiring capitals)

Q66. B (Pronoun 'I' and initialisms NHS / PPE are always capitalised)

Q77. B (Shows contrast between arriving on time and being damaged)

Q88. A ('so' demonstrates direct consequence / logical result)

Q99. B (Middle 'because' links subordinate clause smoothly without comma)

Q1010. B (Introductory subordinate clause requires a comma before the main clause)

Q1111. B (Commas separate list items; 'and' joins the final item)

Q1212. B (Introductory time phrase 'Last Monday morning,' requires a comma)

Q1313. B (Apostrophes sit between 'n' and 't' to replace 'o': shouldn't, don't)

Q1414. B ('It's' = 'It is' essential)

Q1515. A (Singular possession: one supplier's invoice)

Q1616. B (Hissing sound -x adds -es: boxes)

Q1717. B (Irregular plurals: men and children; no -s added)

Q1818. B (Consonant+y → companies; vowel+y → holidays)

Q1919. B (Plural owners ending in -s take terminal apostrophe only: drivers')

Q2020. A (Singular third person subject 'caretaker' requires -s: inspects)

Q2121. B (Present continuous needs auxiliary 'is' + base verb + -ing: is repairing)

Q2222. B (CVC 1-syllable doubling rule: slipped / stopped)

Q2323. B (Standard English past: saw and wrote; not seen/writed)

Q2424. B (Pre-planned intention: are going to upgrade)

Q2525. B (Plural subject 'both apprentices' takes plural past verb 'were')

Q2626. C (Plural noun 'valves' requires plural 'There are')

Q2727. B (Consistent third-person plural: employees → they / their)

Q2828. B (Standard English past 'did'; avoids double negative)

Q2929. B (their = possession; there = location)

Q3030. A (too = excessive; two = 2; to = preposition)

Q3131. A (wear = clothing/PPE; where = location; here = place)

Q3232. A (dis- + connect = disconnected; careful + ly = carefully)

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
depot
sign i
hands

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
weeke
operat

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
Friday
Centra
wear

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
but it
so the
leave

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
down,
drivin
superv

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
screw
morni
unloc

UNIT

Sectio

Sectio
quarte
eyewe
not us

SPAG LEVEL 1 REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

UNIT 8 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. A | 3. A | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. they haven't received the delivery 2. the driver wasn't able to reverse into bay 3 3. It's essential that all doors remain locked.

UNIT 9 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. A | 3. A | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. the nurse's locker 2. We received the client's signature on yesterday's contract. 3. The delivery van has lost its front registration plate.

UNIT 10 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. A | 4. C

Section B (Rewrite): 1. taxes / glasses 2. Several people and their children attended the family open day. 3. Please stack the pallets and wash the trays.

UNIT 11 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. A | 3. A | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. factories / facilities 2. journeys / trays 3. Staff must review all safeguarding policies before taking their annual holidays.

UNIT 12 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. A | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. the teachers' changing room 2. the workers' union 3. We painted the women's staff room yesterday.

UNIT 13 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. A | 2. B | 3. B | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The supervisor inspects the safety log every Friday. 2. The technician washes his hands and goes to the staff room. 3. Every evening, the cleaner empties all the office recycling bins.

UNIT 14 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. B | 4. C

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The network administrator is installing security patches at present. 2. The database backup is stopping due to a connection error. 3. Our team is writing a summary incident report for management.

UNIT 15 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. stopped / dropped 2. tidied / emptied 3. noticed / closed

UNIT 16 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. C | 3. A | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. told / gave 2. saw / spoke 3. The engineer did the repairs and wrote the certificate.

UNIT 17 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. A | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Next Monday, our company is going to upgrade its payment terminals. 2. Apex Solutions will guarantee delivery within forty-eight hours. 3. The supervisor will inspect the work area before signing off.

UNIT 18 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. A | 2. B | 3. B | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. Both security cameras were disabled during the power surge. 2. The list of approved suppliers is pinned to the staff noticeboard. 3. The apprentice and the technician were commended for their quick response.

UNIT 19 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. A | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. There are six replacement air filters on Shelf B. 2. There was only one fire extinguisher in the corridor. 3. There are three visitors waiting at the security gate.

UNIT 20 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. When you lift a heavy box, you must bend your knees. 2. If an apprentice needs advice, they should consult their mentor. 3. Our company values our staff and we reward our team's hard work.

UNIT 21 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. The technician did all the electrical tests this morning. 2. Our team would have completed the order if the power stayed on. 3. The warehouse team has no spare safety helmets.

UNIT 22 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. B | 3. A | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. their 2. There 3. they're

UNIT 23 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. C | 2. B | 3. A | 4. B

Section B (Rewrite): 1. too 2. to 3. two

UNIT 24 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. C | 3. A | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. here / hear 2. where / wear 3. knew / new

UNIT 25 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. C | 2. B | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. misplace 2. disconnect 3. rebuild

SPAG LEVEL 1 REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

UNIT 26 WORKED SOLUTIONS

Section A (Drill): 1. B | 2. A | 3. B | 4. A

Section B (Rewrite): 1. skilful / skillful 2. promptly 3. development

VOCABULARY IN USE ANSWER KEYS (MODULES 1–6)

Module 1: Informal to formal transformation: 'Dear Mr Jenkins, I am writing to request that we reschedule our meeting, as I need to investigate an issue with the delivery vehicle.'

Module 2: Completed instruction: 'Wearing full PPE is mandatory in this workshop because all stored chemicals are highly flammable.'

Module 3: Collocation rewrite: 'I am writing on behalf of my manager to resolve the discrepancy in the invoice before the deadline.'

Module 4: Customer service rewrite: 'While store policy requires a receipt for cash refunds, I would be delighted to provide you with a store credit voucher to rectify the issue.'

Module 5: Spelling rule applications: relied | dropping | receive | shelves

Module 6: Correct words: necessary | business | tomorrow | definitely

MIXED PROOFREADING WORKOUTS (1–6)

Workout 1:
Part A: 1. B | 2. A | 3. B | 4. A
Part B: 1. ...flooded, so the supervisor... 2. Although the apprentice was nervous, he passed... 3. Yesterday morning, our catering team ordered bread, butter, eggs and milk.
Part C: 1. 'welcome' → 'Welcome' | 2. 'weekday it' → 'weekday. It' | 3. 'spacious please' → 'spacious, please' | 4. 'on fridays' → 'On Fridays' | 5. 'early, staff' → 'early. Staff'

Workout 2:
Part A: 1. A | 2. A | 3. B | 4. A
Part B: 1. They can't attend because it's too late. 2. the plumbers' tools 3. The women's locker room was refurbished last month.
Part C: 1. 'contractor's' → 'contractors' | 2. 'workers locker' → 'workers' locker' | 3. 'electricans drill' → 'electrician's drill' | 4. 'torchs' → 'torches' | 5. 'cant' → 'can't'

Workout 3:
Part A: 1. A | 2. B | 3. B | 4. B
Part B: 1. brought / left 2. is going to launch 3. running
Part C: 1. 'notice' → 'noticed' | 2. 'seen that' → 'saw that' | 3. 'runing' → 'running' | 4. 'stoped' → 'stopped' | 5. 'writed' → 'wrote'

Workout 4:
Part A: 1. B | 2. A | 3. B | 4. B
Part B: 1. ...parts was delivered... 2. ...team has no spare... 3. I did the cleaning and saw...
Part C: 1. 'representative was' → 'were' | 2. 'there was four' → 'there were' | 3. 'worker stacks... you must' → 'they must' | 4. 'team leader done' → 'did' | 5. 'didn't receive no' → 'did not receive any'

Workout 5:
Part A: 1. A | 2. A | 3. A | 4. A
Part B: 1. their / there 2. too / two / to 3. here / where / wear
Part C: 1. 'there new' → 'their new' | 2. 'over their' → 'over there' | 3. 'here the fire' → 'hear the fire' | 4. 'see wear' → 'see where' | 5. 'to noisy' → 'too noisy'

Workout 6:
Part A: 1. B | 2. B | 3. A | 4. B
Part B: 1. miscalculated 2. successfully 3. development
Part C: 1. 'carefull' → 'careful' | 2. 'helpfull' → 'helpful' | 3. 'dissappointed' → 'disappointed' | 4. 'politeley' → 'politely' | 5. 'promptley' → 'promptly'

SPAG LEVEL 1 REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

MOCK WRITING EXAMINATION MARK SCHEMES

Mock 1:
1. 'monday' → 'Monday' (Capital letter for day of week)
2. 'sliped' → 'slipped' (Double 'p' after single short vowel in CVC verb)
3. 'wrist, he reported' → 'wrist. He reported' (Comma splice correction)
4. 'worker's lockers' → 'workers' lockers' (Plural possessive for multiple workers)
5. 'cones was placed' → 'cones were placed' (Subject-verb agreement: plural subject takes 'were')
6. 'there tools' → 'their tools' (Possessive pronoun required)
Rubric: Band 3 (5–6 Marks SPaG): Flawless sentence boundaries, correct capitalisation of proper nouns, past simple tense consistency (occurred, slipped, inspected, recommended), correct spelling of vocational words (maintenance, precaution, hazard). Band 3 (5–6 Marks Content): Headline present, clear sequence of events, two realistic preventative measures (e.g. non-slip mats, daily forklift leak checks).

Mock 2:
1. 'yesterday!' → 'yesterday.' (Over-enthusiastic exclamation mark removed for formal letter)
2. 'seen the damage' → 'saw the damage' (Standard English simple past)
3. 'There is two' → 'There are two' (Existential agreement with plural noun 'appliances')
4. 'would of' → 'would have' (Phonetic spelling error corrected)
5. 'company apologise' → 'company apologises' (Singular collective noun agreement)
6. Missing or punctuation adjustments
Rubric: Band 3 (5–6 Marks SPaG): Full formal letter conventions (Dear Mrs Thornton / Yours sincerely), zero non-standard slang, precise punctuation, complex sentence joining (although, because). Band 3 (5–6 Marks Content): Clear confirmation of replacement delivery date, professional apology, specific goodwill gesture or discount offered.

Mock 3:
1. 'Monday all' → 'Monday, all' (Comma required after introductory time clause)
2. 'emergency security' → 'emergency, security' (Comma after introductory prepositional phrase)
3. 'there new' → 'their new' (Possessive homophone error)
4. 'arrives you' → 'arrives, you' (Comma following dependent 'when' clause)
5. 'employees notice... you should' → 'they should' (Pronoun consistency shift)
6. Sentence boundary / capitalisation adjustment
Rubric: Band 3 (5–6 Marks SPaG): Crisp bullet point punctuation, consistent second-person instructional pronouns (you/your), modal verbs (must, should). Band 3 (5–6 Marks Content): Clear email subject header, strong rationale for security, three actionable bullet points.

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS SPAG GLOSSARY

Capital Letter
Used at the start of every sentence, for the word 'I', people's names, places, days, and months.

Full Stop
Punctuation mark (.) used to mark the end of a complete statement.

Question Mark
Punctuation mark (?) used at the end of a direct question.

Exclamation Mark
Punctuation mark (!) used to show strong feeling, surprise, or urgency.

Comma in Lists
Used to separate items in a list (e.g. 'paper, pens, and pencils').

Conjunction
A linking word used to join two sentences (e.g. and, but, so, because).

Past Tense
Verb forms used to describe things that happened yesterday or in the past (e.g. walked, saw).

Present Tense
Verb forms used for things happening now or regularly (e.g. walks, sees).

Subject-Verb Agreement
Matching singular subjects with singular verbs (e.g. 'He works' vs 'They work').

Homophone
Words that sound the same but have different spellings and meanings (e.g. there, their, they're).

SPAG LEVEL 1 REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

SUBJECT & MECHANICS INDEX

A

Annexe D spelling words 50
Apostrophes for omission 28
Apostrophes for possession 30

C

Capital letters 10
Commas in lists 16
Conjunctions (and, but) 18

E

Ending sentences (. ! ?) 12
Exclamation marks 14

F

Full stops 12

H

Homophones (there/their/they're) 44

P

Paragraphs 24
Past tense regular and irregular 20

Q

Question marks 14

S

Subject-verb agreement 22
Suffixes (-ful, -less) 48

U

Using because and so 18

Candidate SPaG Revision Log

LEVEL 1 SPAG STANDARDS

AUDIT

Candidate SPaG Self-Assessment Matrix & Progress Chart

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 SPaG Rubric

Check off your skills against Pearson Edexcel Level 1 standards:

- Write clearly in full sentences with capital letters and full stops.
- Use commas accurately in lists and conjunctions to join ideas.
- Spell everyday workplace words correctly using Annexe D rules.

✎ Personal Progress & Weakness Remediation Log

SIGN

LEVEL 1 SPAG SIGN-OFF

Candidate SPaG Commitment & Tutor Endorsement

Level 1 Professional Literacy Declaration

Confirm your ongoing commitment to professional standards of spelling, punctuation, and grammar:

- **Accurate Demarcation:** Always start every sentence with a capital letter and end with a full stop.
- **Comma Precision:** Use commas accurately in lists and after introductory connective phrases.
- **Everyday Spelling:** Confidently spell core vocational vocabulary without phonics slips.

Audit Habit

Re-read all completed written work before submitting to catch missing punctuation.

Workplace Value

Accurate spelling and clear sentences ensure your workplace messages are understood first time.

✎ Tutor Endorsement & Candidate Next Steps

Master the grammar, spelling and punctuation required for Level 1 English

- **2-Page Murphy 'Grammar in Use' Layout:** Clear visual rules on the left; progressive practice drills on the right.
- **Anti-Glare Cream Canvas:** #FDFBF7 soft background and 13–14pt Lexend font designed specifically for adult and dyslexia learners.
- **Forensic Proofreading:** Authentic workplace emails, letters, and reports with exact error counts to spot and fix.
- **Full Explanatory Solutions:** Step-by-step model rewrites with examiner commentary for every exercise.

PAIR WITH COMPANION WRITING GUIDES

Combine with the **Master Functional Skills Writing Core Guide** to master letters, emails, articles, and reports.

Published by Master Functional Skills
masterfunctionalskills.co.uk • ISBN 978-1-912345-84-5

ISBN 978-1-912345-84-5